



Tourism Deputy Minister accepts Patron & Head of Advisory Board SUSTOURISM-FST

Prof. Ruwan Ranasinghe, Deputy Minister of Tourism, accepted to be the Patron of the Lanka Federation of Sustainable Tourism, when Claude Gunasekera the Initiator of the Organisation proposed the offer at a ceremony held in Colombo.

He will be the Head of Advisory Board or act as the Chief Advisor to the Board although a Chairman is elected whereas he will lead the Advisor Committee.

Prof. Ranasinghe was offered the position based on a clause of the constitution of the Alliance that; 'The Sri Lanka Government's Minister, Deputy Minister or Secretary to the Ministry in charge of Tourism will be offered the honorary position of Patron by constitution.



Prof. D.A.C. Suranga Silva (Professor of Tourism Economics at the University of Colombo and Coordinator Sustainable Tourism Unit, Colombo University, Lead Trainer Global Sustainable Tourism Council (GSTC)., Dr. Samantha Pathirathna (Sustainable Tourism Expert at ADB, Business Master & Coach at Federation of Chamber of Commerce and Industry, Chairman/MD at Eco Treats Tourism), Chandra Wickramasinghe Founder, Chairman/Managing Director of Connaissance De Ceylan, Thema Collection. Prominent Eco-Friendly and Cultural Preservation DMC. Nalin Malwenna. Managing Director HOT Tourism, Tony Maheswaran. Director Strategic Planning, HOT Tourism. Kamal Munasinghe, Chief Operating Officer, Cinnamon Hotels & Resorts nominated Ms. Gayani Punchihewa. Director Rooms Division, Cinnamon Grand Colombo, Eksath Wijeratne, CEO, Browns Hotels & Resorts, Indaka De Silva, Chairman's Representative Barbeyrn Group Conrad Dissanayake, Managing Director, DGSM Travels, Ms. Anitha Munasinghe, Country Manager, Solidaridad, Chinthana Dumindahewa, Country Coordinator (Sri Lanka/Maldives) Green Destinations, Poornaka Delpachithra, Country General Manager / Director - Sri Lanka. Intrepid Travel, Gayan Abeykoon, Media Secretary to Deputy Minister of Tourism, Mahes Bandara, CEO Haritha TV. (Television channel focussed on Nature, Heritage, Local Culture, Folk Arts and Agriculture. Muditha Abeysinghe, Manager Sustainable Tourism Unit SLTDA, Ms. Rajeeeka Ranathunga. Asst. Director STU and the Initiator of the Organisation Claude Gunasekera. Managing Director-StarMedia & Media Consultant HOT Tourism (Pvt) Ltd, Marketing Consultant 7Degree Immersive Restaurant, Colombo 5. Were present at the meeting.

Lanka Federation of Sustainable Tourism, launched recently with unwavering backing, and complete assistance with the endorsement of Sri Lanka Tourism Development Authority (SLTDA) the primary tourism arm of the government. The maiden preliminary meeting was held at the SLTDA Board Room presided by Upali Rathnayake, SLTDA's Deputy Director General and Head of Sustainable Tourism with key Tourism Industry professionals. Sri Lanka does not have a single "exclusive association" for sustainable tourism, but rather a multi-stakeholder approach led by the SLTDA and its Sustainable Tourism Unit (STU). The SLTDA works with the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) to implement the National Sustainable Tourism Certification (NSTC) scheme, partnering with international bodies like the Global Sustainable Tourism Council (GSTC) to foster sustainable practices across the industry, which recognizes tourism businesses committed to environmental, social, and economic sustainability.

